

Admission Policy for Ph.D. Programme

Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan University Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh, offers a structured and research-focused Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) program across multiple disciplines. The program is designed in line with the University Grants Commission (UGC) regulations to cultivate high-quality research and academic excellence. The Ph.D. program at Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan University provides an ideal academic platform for scholars aspiring to contribute significantly to their field of study through rigorous research, guided mentorship, and scholarly publication.

We invite Aspiring researchers to join us at Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan University and Contribute to Advancing Knowledge in their discipline through our Ph.D. programme.

Eligibility Criteria: -

(1) A 1-year/2-semester master's degree program after a 4-year/8-semester bachelor's degree program or a 2-year/4-semester master's degree program after a 3-year bachelor's degree programme or qualifications declared equivalent to the master's degree by the corresponding statutory regulatory body, with at least 55% marks in aggregate or its equivalent grade in a point scale wherever grading system is followed or equivalent qualification from a foreign educational institution accredited by an assessment and accreditation agency which is approved, recognized or authorized by an authority, established or incorporated under a law in its home country or any other statutory authority in that country to assess, accredit or assure quality and standards of the educational institution.

(2) A relaxation of 5% marks or its equivalent grade may be allowed for those belonging to SC/ST/OBC (non-creamy layer)/Differently-Abled, Economically Weaker Section (EWS) and other categories of candidates as per the decision of the Commission from time to time. Provided that a candidate seeking admission after a 4-year/8-semester bachelor's degree program should have a minimum of 75% marks in aggregate or its equivalent grade on a point scale wherever the grading system is followed. A relaxation of 5% marks or its equivalent grade may be allowed for those belonging to SC/ST/OBC (non-creamy layer)/Differently-Abled, Economically Weaker Section (EWS) and other categories of candidates as per the decision of the Commission from time to time.

(3) Candidates who have completed the M.Phil programme with at least 55% marks in aggregate or its equivalent grade in a point scale wherever grading system is followed or equivalent qualification from a foreign educational institution accredited by an assessment and accreditation agency which is approved, recognized or authorized by an authority, established or incorporated under a law in its home country or any other statutory authority in that country to assess, accredit or assure quality and standards of educational institutions, shall be eligible for admission to the Ph.D. programme. A relaxation of 5% marks or its equivalent grade may be allowed for those belonging to SC/ST/OBC (non-creamy layer)/Differently-Abled, Economically Weaker Section (EWS) and other categories of candidates as per the decision of the Commission from time to time.

Duration of the Programme

1. Ph.D. Programme shall be for a minimum duration of three (3) years, including course work, and a maximum duration of six (6) years from the date of admission to the Ph.D. programme.
2. A maximum of an additional two (2) years can be granted through a process of re-registration; provided, however, that the total period for completion of a Ph.D. programme should not exceed eight (8) years from the date of admission in the Ph.D. programme. Provided further that, female Ph.D. scholars and Persons with Disabilities (having more than 40% disability) may be allowed an additional relaxation of two (2) years; however, the total period for completion of a Ph.D. programme in such cases should not exceed ten (10) years from the date of admission in the Ph.D. programme.
3. Female Ph.D. Scholars may be provided Maternity Leave/Child Care Leave for up to 240 days in the entire duration of the Ph.D. programme.

Procedure for Admission

1. The admission shall be based on the criteria notified by the university, keeping in view the guidelines/norms in this regard issued by the UGC and

other statutory/regulatory bodies concerned, and taking into account the reservation policy of the Central/State Government from time to time.

2. University shall notify a prospectus well in advance on the university website specifying the number of seats for admission, subject/discipline-wise distribution of available seats, criteria for admission, the procedure for admission, and all other relevant information for the candidates. University shall adhere to the National/State-level reservation policy, as applicable.
3. University may admit students who qualify for fellowship/scholarship in UGC-NET/UGC- CSIR NET/GATE/CEED and similar National level tests based on an interview. And/or University may admit students through an Entrance Test conducted at the University level. The Entrance Test syllabus shall consist of 50% of research methodology and 50% shall be subject- specific.
4. Students who have secured 50 % marks in the entrance test are eligible to be called for the interview.
5. A relaxation of 5% marks will be allowed in the entrance examination for the candidates belonging to SC/ ST/ OBC/ differently-abled category, Economically Weaker Section (EWS), and other categories of candidates as per the decision of the Commission from time to time.
6. University may decide the number of eligible students to be called for an interview based on the number of Ph.D. seats available.
7. Provided that for the selection of candidates based on the entrance test conducted by the University, a weightage of 70 % for the entrance test and 30 % for the performance in the interview/viva- voce shall be given.
8. University shall maintain a list of Ph.D. supervisors (specifying the name of the supervisor, his or her designation, and the department/school/centre), along with the details of Ph.D. scholars (specifying the name of the registered Ph.D. scholar, the topic of his/her research and the date of admission) admitted under them on the website of the institution and update this list every academic year.

Interview and Allotment

1. Each student shall have to appear in an interview. The interview board shall consist of the following members:
 - i. Vice Chancellor or his Nominee as Chairman
 - ii. Dean of School.
 - iii. One of the Chairman of relevant (BOS) to be nominated by the Vice-Chancellor.
 - iv. Head of University Teaching Departments/ Professor / Associate Professors, nominated by the Vice-Chancellor.
 - v. One of the recognized supervisors in the University Teaching Department in the subject to be nominated by the Vice-Chancellor.
 - vi. One subject expert to be nominated by the Vice-Chancellor.
2. The candidate possesses the competence for the proposed research.
3. The research work can be suitably undertaken at the University.
4. The proposed area of research can contribute to new/additional knowledge.
5. The University shall maintain the list of all the Ph.D. registered students on its website on year- wise basis. The list shall include the name of the registered candidate, topic of his/her research, name of his/her supervisor/co-supervisor, date of enrolment/registration.

Admission of International Student in Ph.D. Programme

1. Each supervisor can guide up to two international research scholars on a supernumerary basis over and above the permitted number of Ph.D. scholars as specified in clause 5.4 in our ordinance.
2. The University may decide their own selection procedure for Ph.D. admission of international students keeping in view the guidelines/norms in this regard issued by statutory/regulatory bodies concerned from time to time.
3. At any point, the total number of Ph.D. scholars under a faculty member, either as a supervisor or a co-supervisor, shall not exceed the number prescribed in clause 5.4 and clause 6.1 in our ordinance.

Course Work

1. The Credit requirement for the Ph.D. coursework is a minimum of 12 credits, including a “Research and Publication Ethics” course as notified by UGC vide D.O. No. F.1-1/2018(Journal/CARE) in 2019 and a research methodology course. The Research Advisory Committee can also recommend UGC recognized online courses as part of the credit requirements for the Ph.D. programme.
2. All Ph.D. scholars, irrespective of discipline, shall be required to train in teaching /education/pedagogy/writing related to their chosen Ph.D. subject during their doctoral period. Ph.D. scholars may also be assigned 4-6 hours per week of teaching/research assistantship for conducting tutorials or laboratory work and evaluations.